

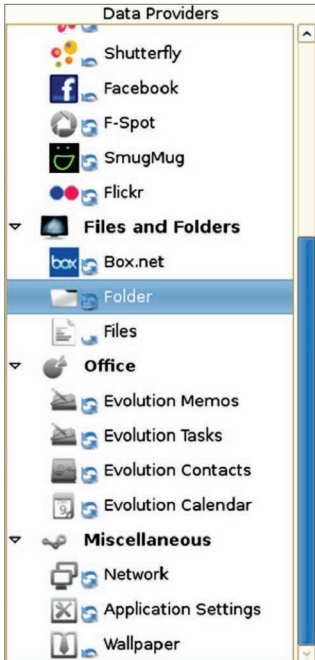


Figure 1: Some services offered by Conduit

a wide variety of applications, including websites, local files and directories, portable media players, bookmarking services, photos and contacts—almost everything a normal desktop user requires.

What makes Conduit a great choice is the way it handles data. In case of multiple services that use the same kind of data, Conduit performs any required data conversion once, and then reuses the data for other services, taking less time, and improving performance.

Some services are unidirectional; you can only receive data from these services. These include RSS

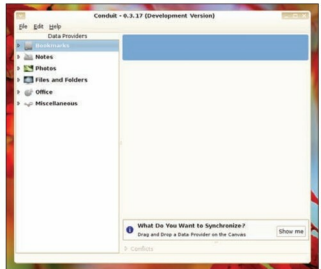


Figure 2: Gnome Conduit

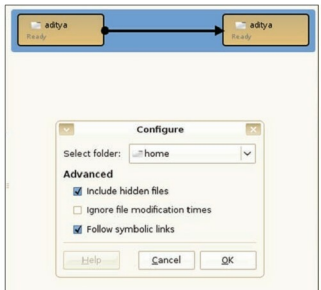


Figure 3: File-synchronisation

feeds and music play-lists. Services like Facebook, on the other hand, only allow data to be dropped into them. You can add photos to Facebook albums from F-Spot, but cannot download them from Facebook. The third service type is mostly file-storage, which allows the flow of data in both directions.

Using Conduit

Once you install Conduit on your system (please refer to the *Installing Conduit* box), start it up, and you will be presented with the view shown in Figure 2. There are two panes by default: the pane on the left lists all the services supported by Conduit, while the one on the right is for configuring *synchronisation options* graphically (hence, it's usually called the canvas). You can actually see the synchronisation process there.